

spinalSynth

Table of Contents

1. Introduction
2. High-Level Architecture
3. Module Hierarchy
4. Master Clock
5. Timing Generators
6. Communication Protocol
7. Oscillator
 - 7.1 System Architecture
 - 7.2 Timing & Control
 - 7.2.1 DDS Update Rate
 - 7.2.2 Atomic Multi-Byte Frequency Updates
 - 7.3 Submodules
 - 7.3.1 Oscillator (Top-Level Wrapper)
 - 7.3.2 Accumulator
 - 7.3.3 Generators
 - 7.3.4 Noise
 - 7.3.5 Mux
 - 7.4 Types and Widths
 - 7.5 Oscillator Register Map
8. Envelope Generator
 - 8.1 EnvelopeGenerator: Top-Level Wrapper
 - 8.2 EnvelopeCtrl
 - 8.2.1 ADSR & Playback Modes
 - 8.2.2 Gate ON/OFF and Hard Sync
 - 8.2.3 State Machine
 - 8.2.4 AD(S)R Lengths: Time Duration Mapping
 - 8.3 EnvelopeAccumulator
 - 8.4 EnvelopeShaper
 - 8.4.1 ROM Lookup tables
 - 8.4.2 Hybrid 8+2 Bit Interpolation Math
 - 8.4.3 Multiplierless Shift-Add Implementation
9. Attenuation & Volume Control
10. Filter (State Variable Filter)
 - 10.1 Architecture
 - 10.2 Timing
 - 10.3 Modules
 - 10.3.1 SVF (Top-Level Wrapper)
 - 10.3.2 Filter Core
 - 10.3.3 Filter Mux
 - 10.3.4 Parameter Mapper
 - 10.4 Types and Widths
 - 10.5 Control Signals
 - 10.6 Filter Register Map
11. Oversampling and Decimation
12. Audio Sample Format
13. I²S Output Interface
14. Numeric Formats
15. System Parameters

Appendices

- [Appendix A: Notes and Oscillator Frequency Words Reference](#)
- [Appendix B: ADSR Time Durations and Phase Increments](#)
- [Appendix C: Register Map](#)

Additional documents for spinalSynth:

- [Implementation_specs.md](#)
- [Testing_specs.md](#)

1. Introduction

This project implements a compact digital audio synthesizer in SpinalHDL.

The core design integrates an oversampled Direct Digital Synthesis (DDS) oscillator, a flexible ADSR envelope generator, a multi-mode State Variable Filter (SVF), and a volume attenuator — all configurable at runtime over a UART register interface. The system produces 16-bit stereo audio serialized using the I²S protocol.

The project is intentionally designed to remain:

- compact
- deterministic
- FPGA- and ASIC-friendly
- easy to understand
- easy to simulate
- easy to extend later

Features

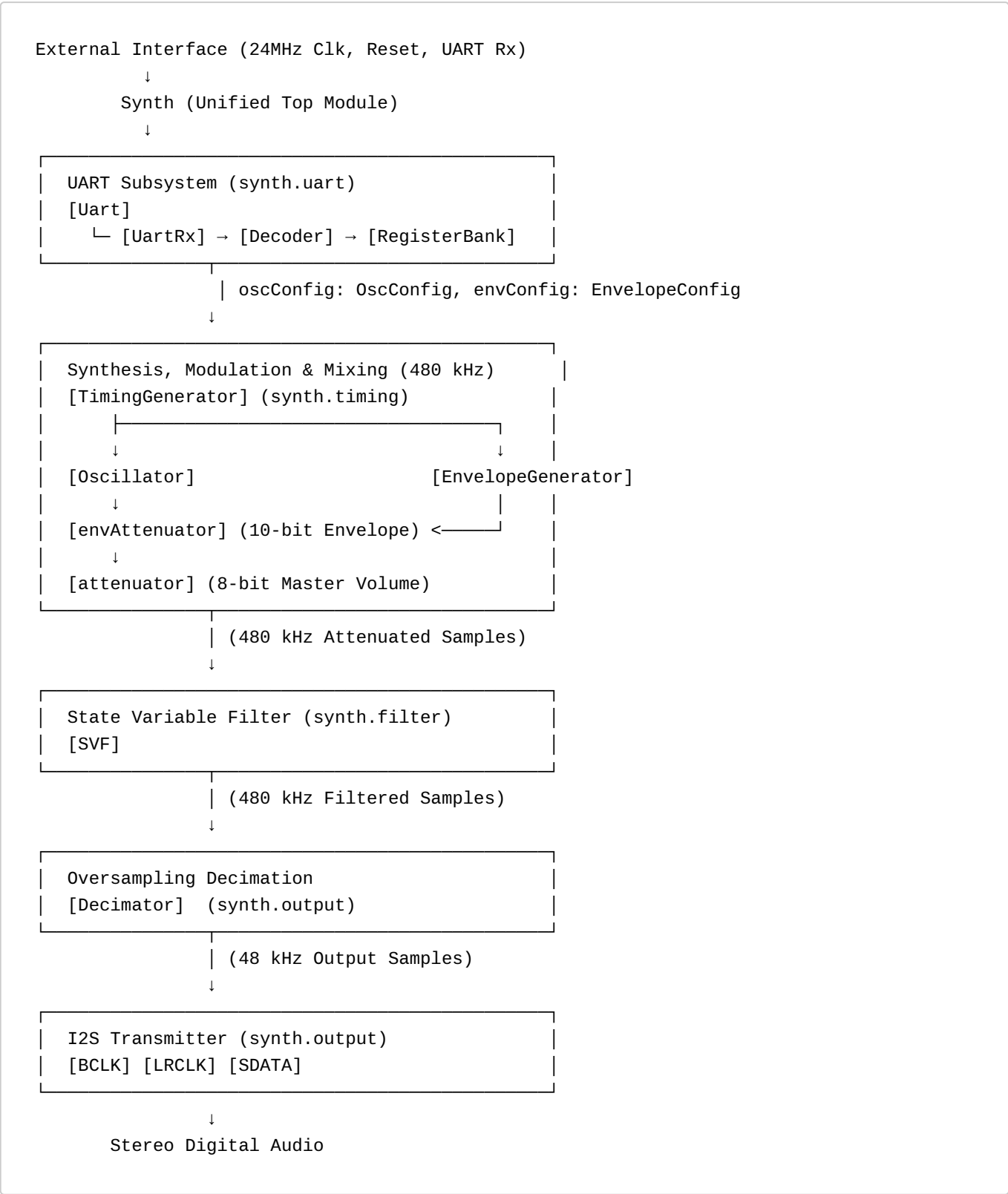
- **24-bit DDS Oscillator:** Generates Saw, Square, PWM, Triangle, and Noise waveforms with 10× oversampling (480 kHz internal update rate downsampled to 48 kHz).
- **Flexible ADSR Envelope:** Supports dynamic rate mapping, four wave-shaping lookup curves (Linear, Exponential, Logarithmic, S-Curve), looping LFO mode, and hardware/software hard-sync prioritization.
- **State Variable Filter (SVF):** Multi-mode Chamberlin filter (LP, BP, HP) with exponential cutoff and quadratic resonance mapping, state saturation protection, and cycle-accurate processing frame synchronization.
- **Control Subsystem:** UART command decoder supporting 3-byte command packets (`WriteRegister`) for dynamic runtime configuration of all parameters.
- **Timing & Output:** Single synchronous 24 MHz clock domain using clock-enable based timing generators and serialized stereo 16-bit signed I²S audio output.

AI: ChatGPT and Gemini

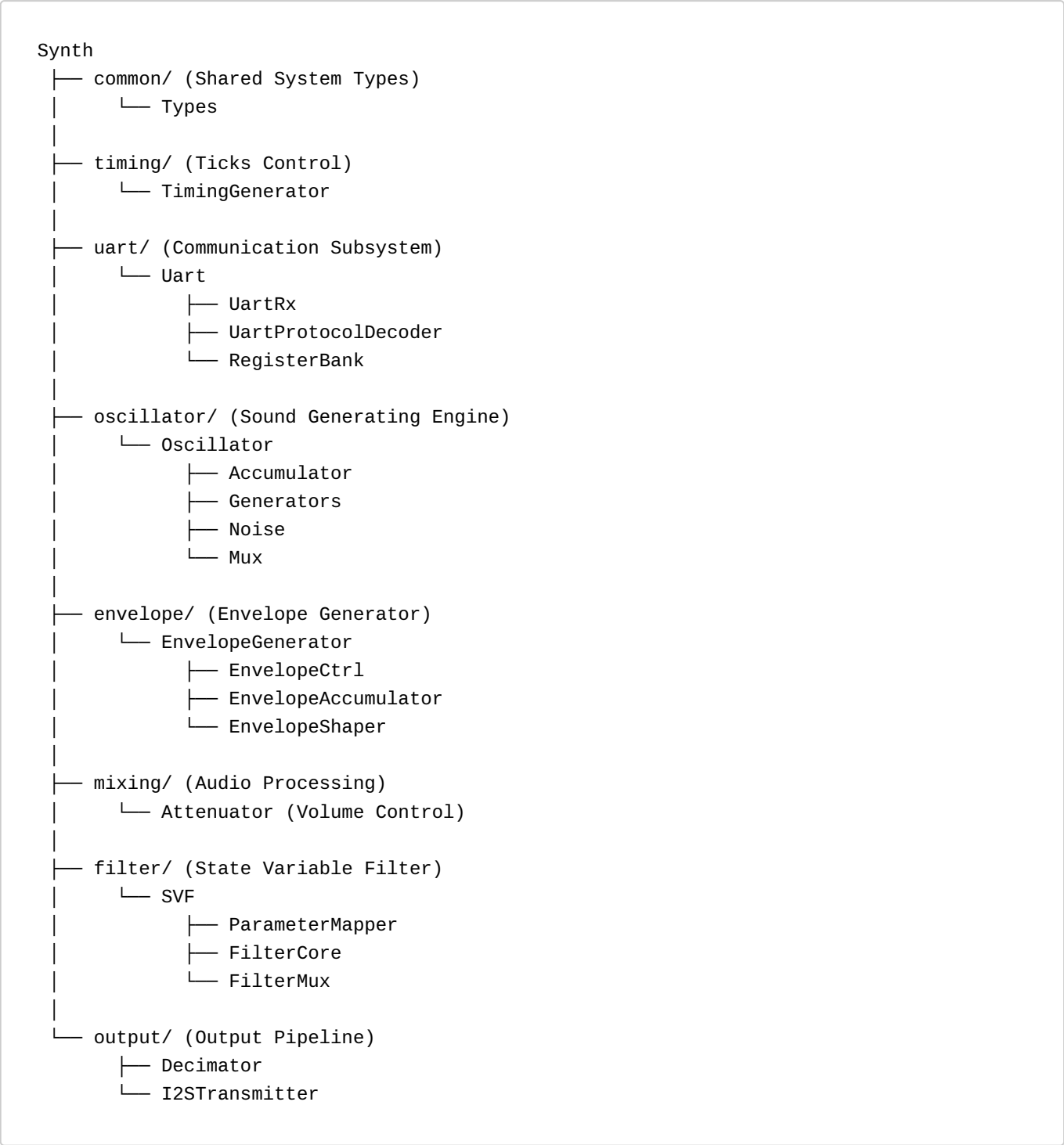
The project was developed with the heavy usage of AI tools. All the specification documents were created via talking sessions to chatGPT, most of them in voice chat on the mobile with follow ups on the keyboard.

Implementation, debugging and testing was done in VSCode with the free Gemini Extension. Later on, i switched the IDE to Antigravity and started paying for Gemini Access (Gemini Pro, Gemini Flash 3.5)

2. High-Level Architecture



3. Module Hierarchy



4. Master Clock

The complete design operates from a single synchronous master clock.

Parameter	Value
Master clock frequency	24 MHz

No internally-generated FPGA clocks shall be used.

All submodules shall operate synchronously from the 24 MHz master clock using clock-enable tick signals.

5. Timing Generators

The TimingGenerator module shall generate two independent clock-enable tick signals.

phaseTick

Parameter	Value
Frequency	480 kHz
Divider	24 MHz / 50
Purpose	Drive DDS phase accumulator

The phase accumulator and waveform generation logic shall update on this tick.

sampleTick

Parameter	Value
Frequency	48 kHz
Divider	24 MHz / 500
Purpose	Generate output audio samples

The decimator and output audio sample registers shall update on this tick.

6. Communication Protocol

The system is controlled via a standard UART interface. An external controller (such as a PC or Microcontroller) sends 3-byte packets to update the internal state of the synthesizer.

UART Configuration

Parameter	Value
Baud Rate	115,200
Data Bits	8
Parity	None
Stop Bits	1

Packet Format

The `UartProtocolDecoder` expects a 3-byte sequence for every command:

1. **Command Byte:** One byte for the command. (i.e. 0x01 for "write to register")
2. **Address Byte:** Specifies which register to write to.
3. **Data Byte:** The value to be written.

Command list

Right now there is only one command.

Command	Name	Adress Byte	Data Byte
0x01	WriteRegister	From Register Map	1 Byte

Register Map

[!NOTE] For the complete list of control registers and memory address offsets mapped into the `spinalSynth` control bus, please refer to [Appendix C: Register Map](#).

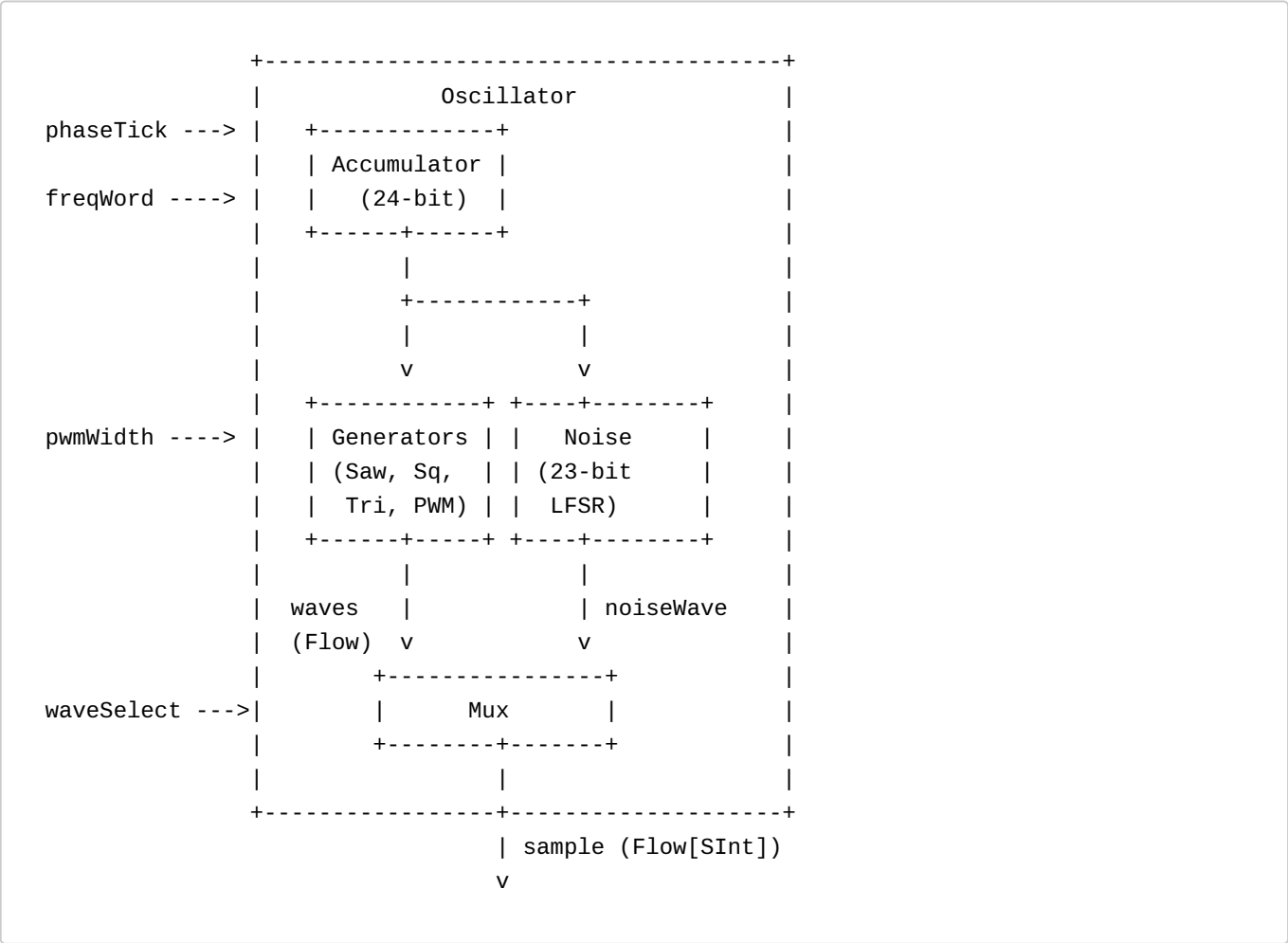
7. Oscillator

The **Oscillator** is the core sound-generating engine of `spinalSynth`, designed around a oversampled Direct Digital Synthesis (DDS) architecture. It generates five standard audio waveforms (Sawtooth, Square, PWM, Triangle, and pseudo-random Noise) at an internal sampling rate of 480 kHz. The output is an 16-bit audio sample flow stream.

The design relies entirely on fixed-point arithmetic, pre-calculated Lookup ROMs, to keep it resource friendly for both FPGA and ASIC targets.

7.1 System Architecture

The architecture consists of four submodules: `Accumulator`, `Generators`, `Noise`, and `Mux`. The diagram below illustrates the connection mapping:



7.2 Timing & Control

7.2.1 DDS Update Rate

The oscillator operates inside the oversampled clock grid driven by the timing generator.

- **Internal Phase Update Rate:** 480 kHz (phaseTick boundary)
- **Clock Synchronization:** Master system clock at 24 MHz
- **Processing Window (Frame):** 50 system clock cycles per update interval

All internal registers update precisely on the rising clock edge when phaseTick is active.

7.2.2 Atomic Multi-Byte Frequency Updates

Since the 24-bit frequency word (freqWord) is configured over the 8-bit UART communication protocol, updates must be performed atomically to prevent transient audio pitch glitches:

1. **OSC_FREQ_LOW (0x00):** Stages the lower 8 bits in a temporary shadow register.
2. **OSC_FREQ_MID (0x01):** Stages the middle 8 bits in a temporary shadow register.
3. **OSC_FREQ_HIGH (0x02):** Stages the upper 8 bits and commits the entire 24-bit word (OSC_FREQ_HIGH ## OSC_FREQ_MID_Shadow ## OSC_FREQ_LOW_Shadow) to the active synthesis registers in a single clock cycle.

Note: Always write registers in order (OSC_FREQ_LOW → OSC_FREQ_MID → OSC_FREQ_HIGH) to ensure consistent updates.

7.3 Submodules

7.3.1 Oscillator (Top-Level Wrapper)

The top-level Oscillator component instantiates the submodules and coordinates the input control signals (config, phaseTick) and output data flows. It packages the selected waveform sample into a SpinalHDL Flow[SInt] interface, where valid is tied directly to phaseTick.

7.3.2 OscAccumulator

The OscAccumulator implements the phase integration logic. At every clock cycle where phaseTick is asserted:

```
phaseReg := phaseReg + freqWord
```

The register is initialized to 0 on reset and wraps naturally on overflow.

DDS Frequency Equations

The output frequency is calculated as:

```
f = freqWord × updateRate / 2^24
```

Where:

- updateRate = 480,000 Hz
- phase width = 24 bits

The minimum frequency resolution step size is:

```
f_step = 480,000 / 16,777,216 ≈ 0.0286 Hz
```

7.3.3 OscGenerators

The `OscGenerators` module contains purely combinational mathematical transformations that convert the 24-bit phase input into various bipolar waveform shapes in a signed 16-bit (`SInt`) range.

Sawtooth Waveform

Generated by extracting the upper 16 bits of the phase accumulator. The Most Significant Bit (MSB) is bitwise inverted ($\wedge 0x8000$) so the ramp starts at the negative peak (-32768) at phase 0, producing a standard rising sawtooth waveform:

```
saw = (phase[23:8] ^ 0x8000)
```

Square Waveform

Generated by evaluating the MSB (bit 23) of the phase accumulator to toggle between positive and negative full-scale bounds:

```
if phase[23] == 1:
    square = +32767
else:
    square = -32768
```

Pulse Width Modulation (PWM) Waveform

Generated by comparing the 24-bit phase accumulator against an expanded threshold:

```
if phase < (pwmWidth << 16):
    pwm = +32767
else:
    pwm = -32768
```

The 8-bit `pwmWidth` value is expanded to 24 bits by left-shifting it by 16 bits, enabling fine duty cycle adjustments.

Triangle Waveform

Generated using a reflected phase technique. The MSB of the phase indicates direction: during the first half-cycle (MSB=0), the lower 23 bits create a rising ramp; during the second half-cycle (MSB=1), they are inverted for a falling ramp. The result is shifted and centered ($\wedge 0x8000$) for a smooth bipolar swing:

```
if phase[23] == 0:
    triReflected = phase[22:0]
else:
    triReflected = ~phase[22:0]

tri = (triReflected[22:7] ^ 0x8000)
```

7.3.4 OscNoise

The OscNoise generator implements a 23-bit pseudo-random Fibonacci Linear Feedback Shift Register (LFSR) updating on every phaseTick to avoid digital correlation loops.

- **Polynomial:** $x^{23} + x^{18} + 1$
- **Feedback Tap Equation:** $feedback = lfsr[22] \wedge lfsr[17]$
- **Reset Seed:** 1 (Non-zero initialization prevents lock-up)
- **Output:** Extracted from the upper 16 bits of the LFSR ($lfsr[22:7]$) cast to a signed integer.

7.3.5 OscMux

The OscMux is a combinational output selector controlled by the 3-bit waveSelect register. It routes the chosen sample to the top-level module:

waveSelect	Selected Waveform
000 (0)	Sawtooth
001 (1)	Square
010 (2)	Pulse Width Modulation (PWM)
011 (3)	Triangle
100 (4)	Pseudo-random Noise
Others	Bipolar Silence (0)

7.4 Types and Widths

Item	Type	Width	Description
phase	UInt	24 bits	Main accumulator phase
freqWord	UInt	24 bits	Phase increment step size
pwmWidth	UInt	8 bits	PWM duty cycle control
waveSelect	UInt	3 bits	Active waveform selection index
waves.saw	SInt	16 bits	Generated sawtooth output
waves.square	SInt	16 bits	Generated square output
waves.pwm	SInt	16 bits	Generated PWM output
waves.tri	SInt	16 bits	Generated triangle output
noiseWave	SInt	16 bits	Generated pseudo-random noise output
sample	SInt	16 bits	Top-level output audio sample

7.5 Oscillator Register Map

The following registers are mapped into the `spinalSynth` bus to control the Oscillator parameters:

Register Address (Hex)	Register Name	Bit Width	Description
0x00	OSC_FREQ_LOW	8 bits	Frequency Word Bits [7:0] (Lower byte of 24-bit DDS step)
0x01	OSC_FREQ_MID	8 bits	Frequency Word Bits [15:8] (Middle byte of 24-bit DDS step)
0x02	OSC_FREQ_HIGH	8 bits	Frequency Word Bits [23:16] (Upper byte of 24-bit DDS step; commit trigger)
0x03	OSC_WAVE_SEL	8 bits	Active waveform selection index (0=Saw, 1=Square, 2=PWM, 3=Triangle, 4=Noise)
0x04	OSC_PWM_WIDTH	8 bits	PWM duty cycle control value (scaled dynamically to 24-bit comparison range)
0x05	OSC_VOLUME	8 bits	Master output volume / output attenuation

8. Envelope Generator

The **Envelope Generator** is a control module designed to shape the volume (amplitude) or other modulation parameters of a sound over time. The general design principle is an ADSR engine.

When a key is pressed (Gate ON), the envelope rises to peak volume (Attack), decays slightly to a steady volume (Decay and Sustain), and then fades to silence when the key is released (Release).

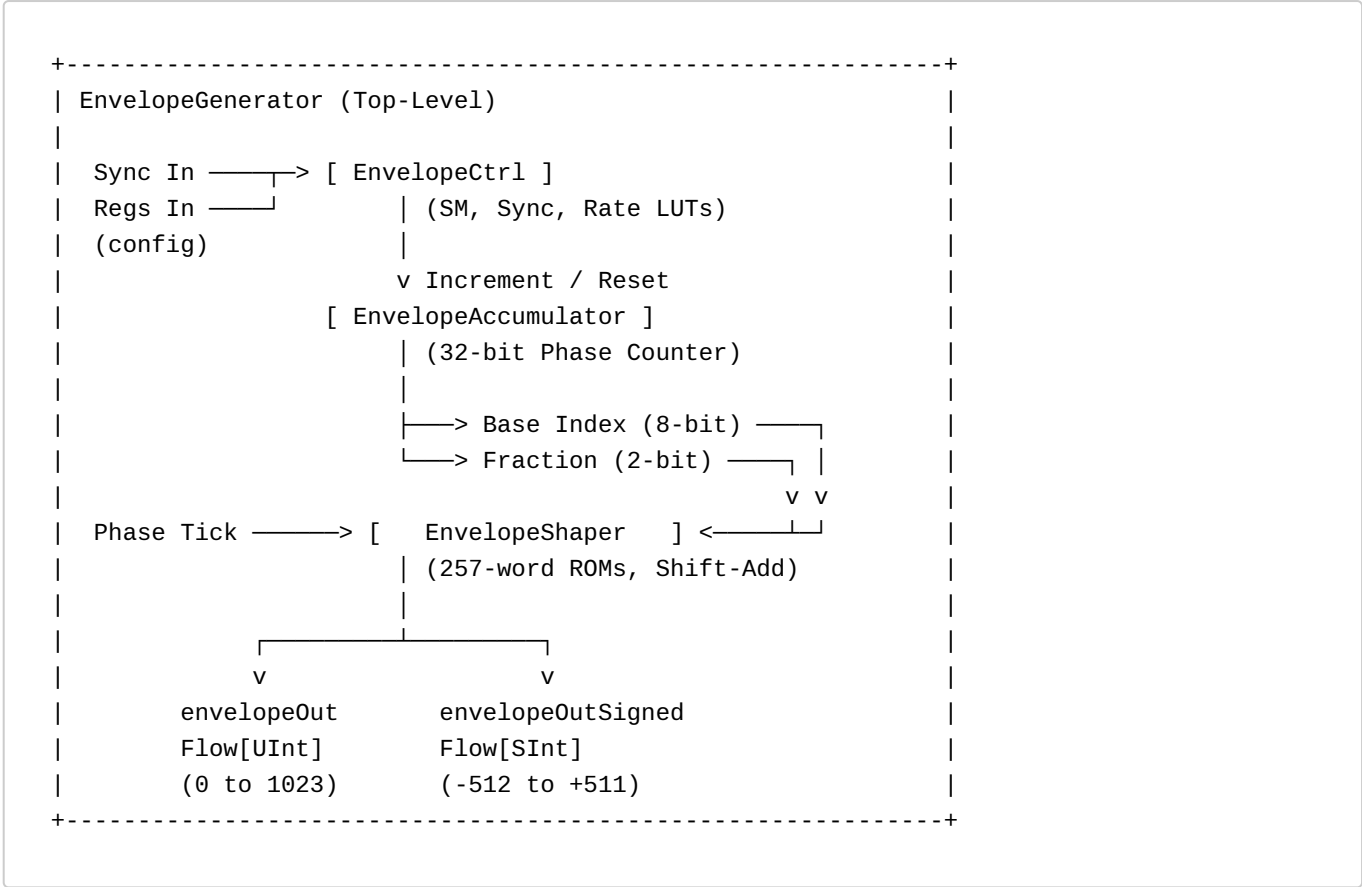
This module generates envelopes with a 10-bit resolution (0 to 1023) output value, which can be used as a volume (or other modulation) signal.

The entire module is designed with ASIC portability in mind, meaning it uses no specific hardware multipliers or memory blocks. Instead, it relies on compile-time Scala calculators to generate look-up curves in ROM, and performs most intermediate steps using bit-shifts and additions.

8.1 EnvelopeGenerator: Top-Level Wrapper

The top-level `EnvelopeGenerator` module integrates the submodules and registers them to the system communication and audio pipelines.

System Diagram



Module Interface (I/O Ports)

The top-level `EnvelopeGenerator` operates directly on the 24 MHz main system clock and exposes the following SpinalHDL hardware IO bundle:

```
val io = new Bundle {
  val phaseTick = in Bool()           // 480 kHz audio rate tick
  val syncIn    = in Bool()           // Trigger for Hard Sync
  val config    = in(EnvelopeConfig()) // Packaged register configurations

  val envelopeOut      = master(Flow(UInt(10 bits))) // Unipolar output (0 to 1023)
  val envelopeOutSigned = master(Flow(SInt(10 bits))) // Bipolar output (-512 to +511)
}
```

- **Unipolar Output (`envelopeOut`):** Emits unsigned 10-bit values (0 to 1023) for standard amplitude scaling or unipolar modulation. The flow's `valid` signal is synchronized to `phaseTick` (480 kHz heartbeat).
- **Bipolar Output (`envelopeOutSigned`):** Emits signed 10-bit values (-512 to +511) for ring modulation, phase modulation, or center-zero pitch modulations. The flow's `valid` signal is synchronized to `phaseTick` (480 kHz heartbeat).

The EnvelopeConfig Bundle

Following the consistent design patterns of the synthesizer's components, the parameter configuration is packaged into a unified Scala bundle under the `synth.common` package:

```
case class EnvelopeConfig() extends Bundle {
  val ctrl      = Bits(8 bits)
  val attack    = UInt(8 bits)
  val decay     = UInt(8 bits)
  val sustain   = UInt(8 bits)
  val release   = UInt(8 bits)
  val gate      = Bits(8 bits)
}
```

Register Map

The following registers are mapped into the `spinalSynth` SPI/UART register bus to control the Generator parameters:

Register Address (Hex)	Register Name	Bit Width	Description
0x40	ENV_CTRL	8 bits	Control bits: [0] ENV_DISABLE (0=active/enabled, 1=disabled), [1] ENV_BYPASS (0=active modulation, 1=bypass modulation), [2] ENV_LOOP (0=single-shot, 1=loop), [3] ENV_HARDSYNC_EN (0=hard sync disabled, 1=hard sync enabled), [5:4] ENV_CURVE (00=Lin, 01=Exp, 10=Log, 11=S-Curve)
0x41	ENV_ATTACK	8 bits	Attack rate (time duration mapped)
0x42	ENV_DECAY	8 bits	Decay rate (time duration mapped)
0x43	ENV_SUSTAIN	8 bits	Sustain Level
0x44	ENV_RELEASE	8 bits	Release rate (time duration mapped)
0x45	ENV_GATE	8 bits	Gate/Sync triggers: [0] Gate ON/OFF, [1] Software Hard Sync

Bits that do not appear in the mapping above are just unused right now.

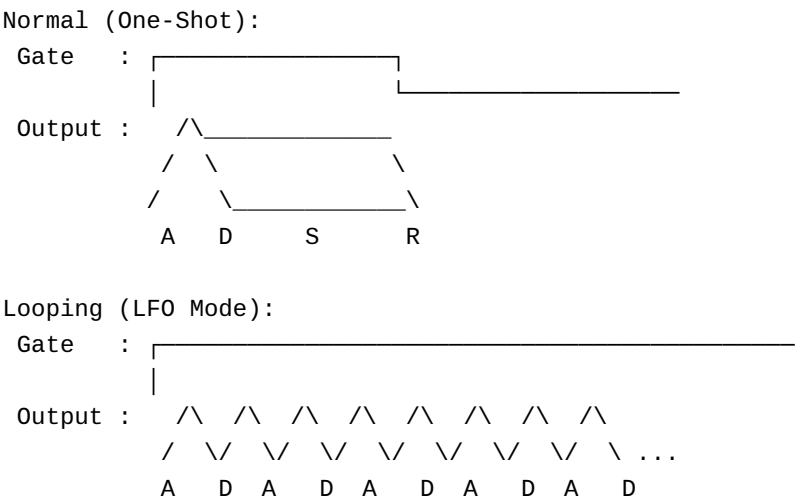
8.2 EnvelopeCtrl

`EnvelopeCtrl` is the state machine and synchronization module that determines the active phase increment values and the play direction.

8.2.1 ADSR & Playback Modes

There are different modes for the ADSR playback envelopes and shapes:

- **Normal (One-Shot):** Triggers on Gate ON, transitions from Attack to Decay to Sustain, and goes to Release on Gate OFF.
- **Looping (LFO Mode):** The envelope automatically loops back to the start of the Attack phase once the Decay phase finishes.

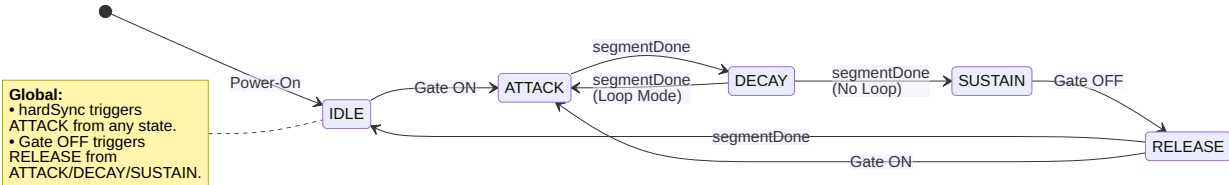


8.2.2 Gate ON/OFF and Hard Sync

- **Gate ON:** Triggers the ADSR envelope to start from the ATTACK phase.
- **Gate OFF:** Triggers the ADSR envelope to go to the RELEASE phase.
- **Hard Sync:** Trigger to instantly reset the Accumulator and send the state machine to ATTACK.

For the exact transitions see the state machine diagram below.

8.2.3 State Machine



8.2.4 AD(S)R Lengths: Time Duration Mapping

In synthesizer design, how parameter values map to actual time durations directly determines the musical feel of the instrument.

Why Linear Mapping Fails

If we map the 8-bit parameters (0 to 255) of the Attack, Decay and Release registers to time durations linearly, we encounter severe playing issues:

- **Linear Time Mapping:** If time increases linearly up to 30.0 seconds, the first step is already 117 milliseconds. This completely wipes out snappy, high-energy percussion attacks (which require precise control between 1 ms and 50 ms).
- **Linear Increment Mapping:** Mapping step size (increment) linearly creates a hyperbola where most of the range is crammed into tiny millisecond adjustments at the fast end, making it practically impossible to select slow durations with any precision.

The Logarithmic Solution

To match human hearing perception, we use a **logarithmic time mapping** (exponential increments). This splits the 8-bit parameter range into three playable musical zones:

- **Register Values 0 to 100:** Snappy transients (0.5 ms to 200 ms) with sub-millisecond precision.
- **Register Values 100 to 200:** Medium decay and release controls (200 ms to 3.0 seconds).
- **Register Values 200 to 255:** Very slow, evolving ambient sweeps (3.0 seconds to 30.0 seconds).

Hardware Implementation: Pre-Calculated ROM

Calculating logarithmic curves or exponential step values at runtime is expensive in ASIC silicon, requiring division blocks and exponential math units.

To maintain ASIC portability, we pre-calculate the 256 increment step values in Scala at compile-time. When a parameter register (Attack, Decay, or Release) is written, the system simply uses the 8-bit value to index a static lookup ROM (256 words x 22-bit width) to retrieve the accumulator step size instantly.

System Specifications:

mainClock = 24 MHz system clock

T_min = 0.5 ms (0.0005 seconds)

T_max = 30.0 seconds

Accumulator Width = 32 bits (10 bits integer + 22 bits fraction)

Increment Width = 22 bits

Mathematical Model:

T(P) = T_min * (T_max / T_min) ^ (P / 255)

increment(P) = 2^32 / (T(P) * 24,000,000)

8.3 EnvelopeAccumulator

The EnvelopeAccumulator acts as the time-tracking motor of the envelope generator, capable of counting in both directions (forward and reverse) depending on the active stage.

How the Accumulator works

The accumulator is a 32-bit register. On every master clock cycle (24 MHz), the accumulator adds (or subtracts) the active 22-bit phase increment value:

- **Attack (Stage 1):** Counts UP (accumDir = 0). segmentDone triggers when it overflows past 1023 (representing index 255).
- **Decay (Stage 2):** Counts DOWN (accumDir = 1). segmentDone triggers when the integer baseIndex matches or crosses below sustainLevel (using an 8-bit hardware comparator).
- **Sustain (Stage 3):** Paused (runAccum = 0), naturally holding the output stable at sustainLevel without any pipeline registers.
- **Release (Stage 4):** Counts DOWN (accumDir = 1). segmentDone triggers when it underflows (representing baseIndex reaching 0).

Clock and Frequency Boundaries

At the 24 MHz main clock rate with a 32-bit accumulator and 22-bit phase increment, the exact operational limits are calculated as follows:

Target Speed Limit	Time Duration	Active Clock Cycles	Calculated Increment (Decimal)	Increment (Hexadecimal)
--------------------	---------------	---------------------	--------------------------------	-------------------------

Target Speed Limit	Time Duration	Active Clock Cycles	Calculated Increment (Decimal)	Increment (Hexadecimal)
Maximum Speed (T_min)	0.5 milliseconds	12,000 cycles	357,914	0x05761A
Minimum Speed (T_max)	30.0 seconds	720,000,000 cycles	6	0x000006

Hardware Phase Specifications

- **Accumulator Size:** Uses a 32-bit phase accumulator (10 bits integer + 22 bits fraction).
- **Segment Limits:** Evaluated dynamically based on FSM state (`overflow` for Attack, `baseIndex <= sustainLevel` for Decay, `underflow` for Release).
- **Output Splitting:** Splits the upper 10 integer bits of the active 32-bit phase (bits 31 to 22) into two fields to drive the waveshaper:
 - **Base Index:** The higher 8 bits of the integer part (bits 31 to 24), representing the active step index (0 to 255).
 - **Fractional Part:** The lower 2 bits of the integer part (bits 23 to 22), representing the interpolation fraction (0 to 3).

8.4 EnvelopeShaper

The `EnvelopeShaper` is the output stage of the envelope generator.

It takes the raw, linear ramp outputs from the accumulator and transforms them into customized, musically natural curves. It reads two consecutive points from a 257-entry curve ROM (Lin, Exp, Log, S-Curve) based on the 8-bit Base Index, performs linear interpolation in pure multiplierless combinational logic using the 2-bit fraction, and outputs unipolar/bipolar audio-rate flows.

8.4.1 ROM Lookup tables

The Base Index (upper 8 bits) addresses lookup curves from pre-calculated 257-word ROMs (257 x 8 bits) using these profiles:

Curve Model	Description	Primary Audio Application
Linear (Lin)	Perfectly straight transition lines.	LFO sweeps, pitch modulation, physical modeling.
Exponential (Exp)	Accelerating curve start, mimicking natural capacitor discharge.	Snappy percussion envelopes, natural string plucks.
Logarithmic (Log)	Rapid initial rise followed by gradual flattening.	High-energy attack dynamics, volume compensation.
S-Curve (Sigmoid)	Smooth cosine-like ease-in and ease-out transitions.	Smooth organic sweeps, cinematic pads, crossfading.

The 257-Entry ROM Boundary Safeguard

To calculate $Y1 = LUT[x+1]$ when the base index is at its boundary ($x = 255$) without conditional bounds checking or wrapping, the curve ROM is constructed with **257 entries** (indices 0 to 256). For $x = 255$, $LUT[x+1]$ safely returns $LUT[256]$, containing the true terminal amplitude value.

8.4.2 Hybrid 8+2 Bit Interpolation Math

Using the splits from the 10 bits accumulator output:

-  and $Y1 = LUT[x+1]$.

- The 2-bit fraction `f` represents step fractions `{0, 1/4, 2/4, 3/4}`.
- **Interpolation:** Evaluates $Y = Y0 + (f / 4) * (Y1 - Y0)$.
- **Reverse Gating:** When counting backwards (`accumDir = 1` during Decay and Release), the 2-bit fractional index is mirrored combinatorially: `fractionAdjusted = accumDir ? (3 - fraction) : fraction` This guarantees that interpolation sweeps smoothly and linearly downward in both directions.

8.4.3 Multiplierless Shift-Add Implementation

The fractional calculation is implemented in pure combinational shift-add logic:

Fractional Bits (<code>f_adjusted</code>)	Fraction Value	Hardware Shift-Add Expression
00	0.00	<code>Y0</code>
01	0.25	<code>Y0 + (delta Y >> 2)</code>
10	0.50	<code>Y0 + (delta Y >> 1)</code>
11	0.75	<code>Y0 + (delta Y >> 1) + (delta Y >> 2)</code>

Since the accumulator physically halts at `sustainLevel` during Sustain and counts backwards naturally during Decay and Release, **no multipliers or sustain delay pipelines are required**, making the output stage extremely area-efficient.

9. Attenuation & Volume Control

Volume level control is performed at the oversampled 480 kHz rate prior to decimation by the `Attenuator` module. To maximize reusable modularity (e.g., interfacing with an 8-bit manual volume register or a 10-bit dynamic envelope generator output), the `Attenuator` is designed as a compile-time parameterized component:

- **Compile-Time Parameter:** `volumeWidth: Int = 8`
- **Inputs:** `io.volume: UInt(volumeWidth bits)`, `io.phaseTick: Bool` (480 kHz grid strobe)
- **Mathematical Operation:**

```
scaledSample = (sampleIn * volumeSigned) >> volumeWidth
```

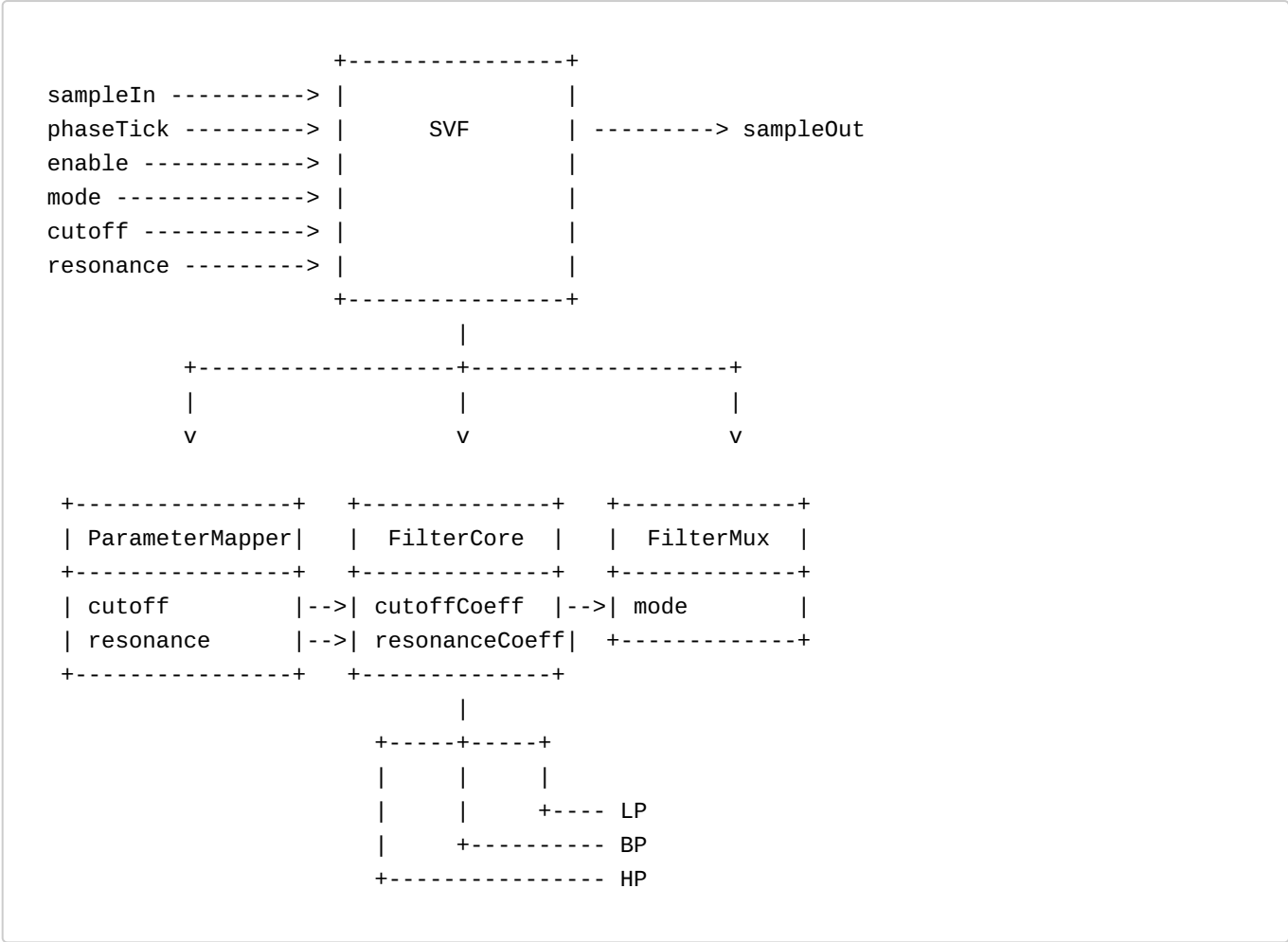
This is implemented efficiently in hardware using a single signed multiplier and bitwise shift scaling. To align the output flow properly with downstream blocks, the `sampleOut.valid` strobe is synchronized combinatorially to the next `phaseTick` edge, introducing exactly 1 sample (1 `phaseTick` period) of latency.

10. Filter (State Variable Filter)

The Filter Module processes audio samples within the `spinalSynth` signal path.

The module architecture shall allow future filter core implementations without changing the external interface.

10.1 Architecture



10.2 Timing

Main system clock

Signal	Frequency
clk	24 MHz

External: Sample Interface Sync

The Filter Module receives and transmits audio samples at a rate of 480 kHz. Input and output samples are transferred using SpinalHDL Flow interfaces. A dedicated input signal `phaseTick` is provided.

Signal	Rate
phaseTick	480 kHz

The input and output Flow interfaces are synchronized to `phaseTick`. All signals remain synchronous to the 24 MHz main system clock.

Internal: Processing frame

One frame of the external sample sync is 50 main clock cycles long. Calculations can be distributed across multiple system clock cycles during this. Internal processing is not required to use a fully parallel or serial datapath; mixed design is allowed.

10.3 Modules

10.3.1 SVF (Top-Level Wrapper)

SVF combines `FilterCore`, `FilterMux`, and `ParameterMapper`, and handles the connection of all input and output signals.

10.3.2 Filter Core

`FilterCore` is a Chamberlin State Variable Filter (SVF). It supports runtime adjustment of:

- Cutoff
- Resonance

and it provides these outputs simultaneously:

- Lowpass (lp)
- Bandpass (bp)
- Highpass (hp)

The name SVF (State Variable) refers to two of these passes being internal state variables:

- Lowpass state (lp)
- Bandpass state (bp)

Calculation

For each input sample, the Highpass (hp), Bandpass (bp) and Lowpass (lp) outputs are calculated from the current filter states, and then the states are updated.

Basic equations:

```
hp = input - lp - resonance * bp
bp = bp + cutoff * hp
lp = lp + cutoff * bp
```

Per sample, the filter requires:

- 3 multiplications
- 4 add/sub operations

The algorithm operates entirely on fixed-point values and uses only:

- Registers
- Adders/Subtractors
- Multipliers

Multiplier results use extended precision internally. After each multiplication, the result shall be rescaled (downshifted) to the internal state width before being used in subsequent calculations or written back into a state register.

The internal state width remains constant throughout the filter pipeline and shall not grow between processing stages.

Example Width Propagation

```

bp(24) * resonance(8)
  -> 32 bit product
  -> downshift by 8
  -> 24 bit result

input(16)
  -> sign extend
  -> 24 bits

input(24) - lp(24)
  -> 25 bit result

(input - lp)(25) - resBp(24)
  -> 26 bit result

resize
  -> hp(24)

hp(24) * cutoff(12)
  -> 36 bit product
  -> downshift by 12
  -> 24 bit result

bp(24) + scaledProduct(24)
  -> 25 bit result

resize
  -> bp(24)

bp(24) * cutoff(12)
  -> 36 bit product
  -> downshift by 12
  -> 24 bit result

lp(24) + scaledProduct(24)
  -> 25 bit result

resize
  -> lp(24)

```

Arithmetic operations may temporarily increase signal widths. Before values are stored into state registers or used as the next state variable, they shall be resized to the defined internal state width.

The state registers `lp` and `bp` remain 24 bits wide throughout operation.

10.3.3 Filter Mux

`FilterMux` is responsible for output selection. The initial implementation shall support selection of:

- Lowpass
- Bandpass
- Highpass

responses.

It is also responsible for downsizing the internal 24-bit representation back to the 16-bit output. To prevent harsh wrap-around distortion when filter outputs exceed 16-bit signed boundaries (due to filter peaking or phase-shift overshoot), the module shall apply a saturating clamp to output values, limiting output samples strictly to `[-32768, 32767]`.

10.3.4 Parameter Mapper

`ParameterMapper` converts user-facing parameters into internal filter coefficients.

Cutoff Mapping

- Input: `UInt(8)`
- Output: `UInt(12)`
- ROM: `256 x 12`
- Mapping: exponential (log-like frequency distribution)

Resonance Mapping

- Input: `UInt(8)`
- Output: `UInt(8)`
- ROM: `256 x 8`
- Mapping: quadratic response curve

10.4 Types and Widths

Item	Type
sampleIn	<code>SInt(16 bits)</code>
sampleOut	<code>SInt(16 bits)</code>
lp state	<code>SInt(24 bits)</code>
bp state	<code>SInt(24 bits)</code>
hp signal	<code>SInt(24 bits)</code>
cutoff	<code>UInt(8 bits)</code>
resonance	<code>UInt(8 bits)</code>
cutoffCoeff	<code>UInt(12 bits)</code>
resonanceCoeff	<code>UInt(8 bits)</code>

10.5 Control Signals

Signal	Type
enable	<code>Bool</code>
mode	<code>UInt(2 bits)</code>

Mode encoding:

Value	Response
00	Lowpass
01	Bandpass

Value	Response
10	Highpass
11	Reserved

The control signals are inputs to the top-level SVF module and distributed internally.

When `FILTER_DISABLE` is asserted (set to 1), the module output shall be zero.

Bypass functionality is handled at the toplevel `Synth.scala` multiplexer, routing audio around the SVF module when `FILTER_BYPASS` is active.

10.6 Filter Register Map

The following registers are mapped into the `spinalSynth` bus to control the SVF parameters:

Register Address (Hex)	Register Name	Bit Width	Description
0x50	<code>FILTER_CTRL</code>	8 bits	Bit [0]: <code>FILTER_DISABLE</code> (0=active/enabled, 1=disabled), Bit [1]: <code>FILTER_BYPASS</code> (0=filter in audio path, 1=bypass filter)
0x51	<code>FILTER_MODE</code>	8 bits	Bits [1:0]: Response Mode (00=LP, 01=BP, 10=HP, 11=Reserved)
0x52	<code>FILTER_CUTOFF</code>	8 bits	8-bit user cutoff value (mapped exponentially)
0x53	<code>FILTER_RESONANCE</code>	8 bits	8-bit user resonance value (mapped quadratically)

11. Oversampling and Decimation

Oversampling Strategy

The oscillator shall internally operate at:

480 kHz

while the final audio output sample rate shall be:

48 kHz

This creates an oversampling ratio of:

10×

Decimation Strategy

The implementation shall use simple zero-order decimation.

Every 10th sample shall be captured as the output audio sample.

No interpolation or low-pass filtering shall initially be used.

Example:

```
if(sampleTick) {
    audioSample := oscSample
}
```

12. Audio Sample Format

Parameter	Value
Audio width	16 bit
Sample format	Signed
Sample rate	48 kHz

Example:

```
val sample = SInt(16 bits)
```

The oscillator is currently mono internally.

The mono signal shall be duplicated to both stereo output channels.

Example:

```
leftSample = sample
rightSample = sample
```

13. I²S Output Interface

The output interface shall use the I²S protocol.

I²S Timing Architecture

The I²S transmitter shall operate directly from the 24 MHz master clock. The transmitter shall use a cycle-timed state machine architecture.

I²S Bit Timing

The required I²S bit clock frequency BCLK is:

$$48,000 \times 2 \times 16 = 1.536 \text{ MHz}$$

The relationship to the 24 MHz master clock is:

$$24 \text{ MHz} / 1.536 \text{ MHz} = 15.625$$

Therefore no integer divider exists.

The serializer shall therefore alternate between:

- 15 master-clock cycles
- 16 master-clock cycles

between serialized bit transfers.

I²S Timing Subpattern

The serializer shall use the following repeating 8-step timing subpattern:

$$16, 16, 15, 16, 16, 15, 16, 15$$

This subpattern contains:

Interval	Count
16-cycle intervals	5
15-cycle intervals	3

Total clocks:

$$16+16+15+16+16+15+16+15 = 125$$

Average clocks per bit:

$$125 / 8 = 15.625$$

This exactly matches the required average I²S bit timing.

Relationship To LRCLK Period

One stereo I²S frame contains:

32 serial bits

because:

- 16 left-channel bits
- 16 right-channel bits

Since:

$$32 = 4 \times 8$$

the 8-step timing subpattern repeats exactly four times during one complete stereo frame.

Full frame timing:

$$[16, 16, 15, 16, 16, 15, 16, 15] \times 4$$

Total master-clock cycles per stereo frame:

$$4 \times 125 = 500$$

Stereo frame rate:

$$24 \text{ MHz} / 500 = 48 \text{ kHz}$$

This produces the exact required audio sample rate.

I²S Timing State Machine

The serializer shall internally contain:

Register	Purpose
cycleCounter	Current interval countdown
patternIndex	Selects 15/16-cycle interval
bitCounter	Counts serialized bits
shiftRegister	Serialized audio data

The pattern index shall cycle continuously:

$$0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 0$$

The bit counter shall cycle:

```
0 → 1 → 2 → ... → 31 → 0
```

The bit counter determines:

- LRCLK state
- stereo frame boundaries
- sample reload timing

I²S Audio Format

Parameter	Value
Channels	2
Audio width	16 bit
Sample rate	48 kHz
Bit clock	1.536 MHz

I²S Signals

Signal	Description
i2s_bclk	Bit clock
i2s_lrclk	Left/right word select
i2s_sdata	Serial audio data

Serializer Behavior

The I²S serializer shall:

- shift audio data
- serialize stereo audio samples
- generate LRCLK framing
- output signed 16-bit audio samples

The exact serializer state machine behavior is not yet specified.

14. Numeric Formats

Signal	Type
phase	UInt(24 bits)
freqWord	UInt(24 bits)
pulseWidth	UInt(8 bits)
audioSample	SInt(16 bits)

Signal	Type
volume	UInt(volumeWidth bits)
lp state	SInt(24 bits)
bp state	SInt(24 bits)
hp signal	SInt(24 bits)

The design shall use fixed-point arithmetic throughout.

Grouped Bundles & Flow Interfaces

Bundle	Subfields	Type
RegisterWrite	address	UInt(8 bits)
	data	Bits(8 bits)
OscConfig	freqWord	UInt(24 bits)
	waveSelect	UInt(3 bits)
	pwmWidth	UInt(8 bits)
	volume	UInt(8 bits)
OscWaveforms	saw	SInt(16 bits)
	square	SInt(16 bits)
	pwm	SInt(16 bits)
	tri	SInt(16 bits)

15. System Parameters

Parameter	Value
HDL	SpinalHDL
Master clock	24 MHz
DDS phase width	24 bit
DDS update rate	480 kHz
Audio sample rate	48 kHz
Audio width	16 bit signed
I²S output	Stereo
I²S bit clock	1.536 MHz
Oversampling ratio	10×
Decimation method	Every 10th sample
Filter	State Variable Filter (SVF)
Filter modes	Lowpass, Bandpass, Highpass
Arithmetic	Fixed-point
Waveforms	Saw, Square, PWM, Triangle, Noise
Clocking strategy	Single synchronous clock domain

Appendices

Appendix A: Notes and Oscillator Frequency Words Reference

This table provides the mapping between musical notes (C0 to C8), their fundamental frequencies, and the corresponding 24-bit freqWord values required for the Oscillator DDS engine.

System Parameters:

- Phase Update Rate: 480 kHz
- Phase Width: 24 bits
- Tuning: A4 = 440 Hz

Note	Freq (Hz)	Hex	Dec	Note	Freq (Hz)	Hex	Dec
C0	16.35	0x00023B	571	C4	261.63	0x0023B2	9138
C#0	17.32	0x00025D	605	C#4	277.18	0x0025CD	9677
D0	18.35	0x000281	641	D4	293.66	0x00280D	10253
D#0	19.45	0x0002A7	679	D#4	311.13	0x002A76	10870
E0	20.60	0x0002D0	720	E4	329.63	0x002D05	11525
F0	21.83	0x0002FB	763	F4	349.23	0x002FBA	12218
F#0	23.12	0x000328	808	F#4	369.99	0x00328E	12942
G0	24.50	0x000358	856	G4	392.00	0x00358A	13706
G#0	25.96	0x00038B	907	G#4	415.30	0x0038B4	14516
A0	27.50	0x0003C1	961	A4	440.00	0x003C13	15379
A#0	29.14	0x0003FA	1018	A#4	466.16	0x003FA7	16295
B0	30.87	0x000436	1078	B4	493.88	0x004368	17256
C1	32.70	0x000476	1142	C5	523.25	0x004764	18276
C#1	34.65	0x0004B9	1209	C#5	554.37	0x004B99	19353
D1	36.71	0x000502	1282	D5	587.33	0x00501B	20507
D#1	38.89	0x00054F	1359	D#5	622.25	0x0054EC	21740
E1	41.20	0x0005A1	1441	E5	659.26	0x005A0B	23051
F1	43.65	0x0005F7	1527	F5	698.46	0x005F73	24435
F#1	46.25	0x000652	1618	F#5	739.99	0x00651D	25885
G1	49.00	0x0006B1	1713	G5	783.99	0x006B14	27412
G#1	51.91	0x000717	1815	G#5	830.61	0x007168	29032
A1	55.00	0x000783	1923	A5	880.00	0x007827	30759
A#1	58.27	0x0007F5	2037	A#5	932.33	0x007F4E	32590
B1	61.74	0x00086D	2157	B5	987.77	0x0086CF	34511

Note	Freq (Hz)	Hex	Dec	Note	Freq (Hz)	Hex	Dec
C2	65.41	0x0008ED	2285	C6	1046.50	0x008EC9	36553
C#2	69.30	0x000973	2419	C#6	1108.73	0x009733	38707
D2	73.42	0x000A03	2563	D6	1174.66	0x00A035	41013
D#2	77.78	0x000A9D	2717	D#6	1244.51	0x00A9D8	43480
E2	82.41	0x000B41	2881	E6	1318.51	0x00B416	46102
F2	87.31	0x000BEE	3054	F6	1396.91	0x00BEE7	48871
F#2	92.50	0x000CA4	3236	F#6	1479.98	0x00CA39	51769
G2	98.00	0x000D63	3427	G6	1567.98	0x00D629	54825
G#2	103.83	0x000E2D	3629	G#6	1661.22	0x00E2D1	58065
A2	110.00	0x000F05	3845	A6	1760.00	0x00F04D	61517
A#2	116.54	0x000FEA	4074	A#6	1864.66	0x00FE9D	65181
B2	123.47	0x0010DA	4314	B6	1975.53	0x010D9F	69023
C3	130.81	0x0011D9	4569	C7	2093.00	0x011D91	73105
C#3	138.59	0x0012E6	4838	C#7	2217.46	0x012E66	77414
D3	146.83	0x001407	5127	D7	2349.32	0x01406B	82027
D#3	155.56	0x00153B	5435	D#7	2489.02	0x0153B1	86961
E3	164.81	0x001683	5763	E7	2637.02	0x01682B	92203
F3	174.61	0x0017DD	6109	F7	2793.83	0x017DCE	97742
F#3	185.00	0x001947	6471	F#7	2959.96	0x019472	103538
G3	196.00	0x001AC5	6853	G7	3135.96	0x01AC51	109649
G#3	207.65	0x001C5A	7258	G#7	3322.44	0x01C5A1	116129
A3	220.00	0x001E0A	7690	A7	3520.00	0x01E09A	123034
A#3	233.08	0x001FD3	8147	A#7	3729.31	0x01FD3A	130362
B3	246.94	0x0021B4	8628	B7	3951.07	0x021B3F	138047
				C8	4186.01	0x023B23	146211

Appendix B: ADSR Time Durations and Phase Increments

Here is the Markdown table mapping the Attack/Decay/Release 8-bit register values (P) to the actual segment time durations (T), alongside their pre-calculated **22-bit Phase Increment ROM values** in both decimal and hexadecimal formats (clock frequency = 24 MHz, 32-bit accumulator).

Register Value (P)	Time Duration (T)	Phase Increment (inc - Decimal)	Phase Increment (inc - Hex)
0	0.50 ms (0.00050 s)	357,914	0x05761A (Max speed)
8	0.71 ms (0.00071 s)	253,440	0x03DE00
16	1.00 ms (0.00100 s)	179,462	0x02BD06
24	1.41 ms (0.00141 s)	127,078	0x01F066
32	1.99 ms (0.00199 s)	89,984	0x015F80
40	2.81 ms (0.00281 s)	63,718	0x00F8E6
48	3.97 ms (0.00397 s)	45,119	0x00B03F
56	5.60 ms (0.00560 s)	31,949	0x007CCD
64	7.91 ms (0.00791 s)	22,623	0x00585F
72	11.17 ms (0.01117 s)	16,020	0x003E94
80	15.78 ms (0.01578 s)	11,344	0x002C50
88	22.28 ms (0.02228 s)	8,032	0x001F60
96	31.46 ms (0.03146 s)	5,688	0x001638
104	44.43 ms (0.04443 s)	4,028	0x000FBC
112	62.75 ms (0.06275 s)	2,852	0x000B24
120	88.62 ms (0.08862 s)	2,019	0x0007E3
128	125.15 ms (0.12515 s)	1,430	0x000596
136	176.73 ms (0.17673 s)	1,013	0x0003F5

Register Value (P)	Time Duration (T)	Phase Increment (inc - Decimal)	Phase Increment (inc - Hex)
144	249.59 ms (0.24959 s)	717	0x0002CD
152	352.47 ms (0.35247 s)	508	0x0001FC
160	497.77 ms (0.49777 s)	360	0x000168
168	702.96 ms (0.70296 s)	255	0x0000FF
176	992.73 ms (0.99273 s)	180	0x0000B4
184	1.40 s (1.40196 s)	128	0x000080
192	1.98 s (1.97987 s)	90	0x00005A
200	2.80 s (2.79602 s)	64	0x000040
208	3.95 s (3.94859 s)	45	0x00002D
216	5.58 s (5.57629 s)	32	0x000020
224	7.87 s (7.87495 s)	23	0x000017
232	11.12 s (11.12118 s)	16	0x000010
240	15.71 s (15.70556 s)	11	0x00000B
248	22.18 s (22.17973 s)	8	0x000008
255	30.00 s (30.00000 s)	6	0x000006 (Min speed)

Appendix C: Register Map

The following registers are mapped into the `spinalSynth` bus to control the synthesizer and filter parameters:

Address	Register Name	Description	Width
0x00	OSC_FREQ_LOW	Frequency Word Bits [7:0]	8 bit
0x01	OSC_FREQ_MID	Frequency Word Bits [15:8]	8 bit
0x02	OSC_FREQ_HIGH	Frequency Word Bits [23:16]	8 bit
0x03	OSC_WAVE_SEL	0:Saw, 1:Square, 2:PWM, 3:Triangle, 4:Noise	3 bit
0x04	OSC_PWM_WIDTH	Duty cycle for PWM waveform	8 bit
0x05	OSC_VOLUME	Master output volume / output attenuation	8 bit
0x40	ENV_CTRL	Envelope Control: [0] Disable, [1] Bypass, [2] Loop, [3] Hard Sync Enable, [5:4] Curve (00=Lin, 01=Exp, 10=Log, 11=S-Curve)	8 bit
0x41	ENV_ATTACK	Attack rate coefficient	8 bit
0x42	ENV_DECAY	Decay rate coefficient	8 bit
0x43	ENV_SUSTAIN	Sustain level (0 to 255)	8 bit
0x44	ENV_RELEASE	Release rate coefficient	8 bit
0x45	ENV_GATE	Envelope Gate: [0] Gate ON/OFF, [1] Software Hard Sync	8 bit
0x50	FILTER_CTRL	Filter Control: [0] Disable, [1] Bypass	8 bit
0x51	FILTER_MODE	Filter response mode: [1:0] Mode (00=LP, 01=BP, 10=HP, 11=Reserved)	8 bit
0x52	FILTER_CUTOFF	Cutoff frequency parameter	8 bit
0x53	FILTER_RESONANCE	Resonance feedback parameter	8 bit